# Do I get the new $6,000 senior deduction?

**$6,000** **per person 65 or older, for tax years 2025 through 2028. $12,000 for a married couple if both qualify.**

> "Starting in 2025 and through 2028, individuals who are age 65 or older can claim a new additional deduction of $6,000. This deduction is in addition to the current standard deduction available to seniors under existing law."
>
> "Qualified individuals can claim the enhanced deduction for seniors whether they claim the standard deduction or itemize deductions."
>
> **IRS Publication 6142 and Publication 554**

| | |
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| **INCOME LIMIT** | It shrinks above $75,000 of modified adjusted gross income ($150,000 joint), by 6% of the amount over. Our arithmetic, following the IRS worksheet: single at $80,000 gets $5,700; both 65+, joint at $160,000, $5,400 each. |
| **NOT FOR** | Married people filing separately: "If married, you must file jointly to claim this deduction." You also need a valid Social Security number. |
| **WHERE** | Schedule 1-A of your 2026 return. (The draft 2026 forms move the line number, so ask your preparer.) |

**YOURS**

Born before January 2, 1962? me: yes / no spouse: yes / no _____

**Checked 3 Nov 2026 at:** irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/p6142.pdf · irs.gov/publications/p554 · irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/f1040s1a.pdf · irs.gov/pub/irs-dft/f1040s1a--dft.pdf

# Turning 65 on January 1, 2027? You count for 2026

# Dec 31

**The IRS counts you as 65 the day before your 65th birthday: for a January 1, 2027 birthday, that's December 31, 2026.**

> "You are considered age 65 on the day before your 65th birthday. Therefore, you are considered age 65 at the end of the year if your 65th birthday is on or before January 1 of the following year."
>
> **IRS Publication 554, Tax Guide for Seniors**

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| **SO, FOR 2026** | The draft 2026 Schedule 1-A asks whether you "were born before January 2, 1962". Someone born on January 1, 1962 counts as 65 at the end of 2026. |
| **SAME AT SSA** | Social Security's rule is alike: "A person born on 1/1/1962 attains age 65 on 12/31/2026." |
| **WHAT TO DO** | If you or your spouse were born on January 1, 1962, tell whoever does your taxes. It can change the extra deductions on pages 26 and 28. |

**YOURS**

My birthday: _____

My spouse's birthday: _____

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